Addressing the global misinformation crisis one flag at a time

RedFlag

The future of fact checking

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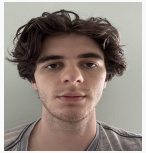
Our *team*



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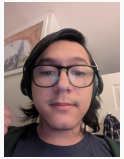

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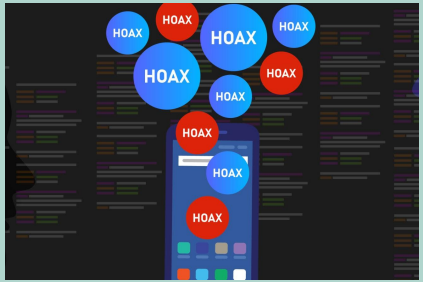
Misinformation in our Digital Ecosystem

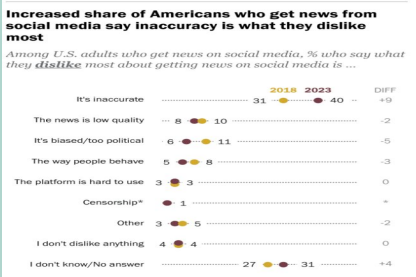


- 94% of people report encountering misinformation online (The Alan Turing Institute, 2024)
- Social media is a major news source for Americans (Pew Research Center, 2024)
- Concerns about inaccurate information on social media are rising (Pew Research Center, 2024)

The problem plaguing online news

Despite the vastly popular concern in regarding digital inaccuracy, social media users frequently propagate misinformation because existing verification methods are inconvenient and require active user intervention. There is a critical need for a passive, real-time tool that bridges the gap between content consumption and fact-checking for daily social media users.

The Scale of Misinformation Exposure



Pew Research Center. (2024, February 7)

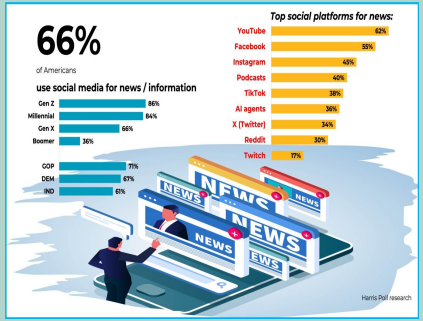
- 40% of Americans who get news from social media cite inaccuracy as their biggest concern. (Pew Research Center, 2024)
- Only 37% say they trust information from social media platforms. (Pew Research Center, 2023)
- 38.2% of U.S. news consumers report unknowingly sharing fake news. (Redline Digital, 2024)

Why does this matter?

When misinformation spreads:

- Public trust declines (Pew Research Center, 2023)
- Users feel concerned but lack effective tools (Pew Research Center, 2024)
- False information spreads unintentionally (Redline Digital, 2024)

Who does this affect?



- Users of social media
  - Teens
    - 85% of young people now get their news primarily from social media. (Stagwell, 2025)
  - 55+
    - On Twitter, 80% of fake news was shared by users over age 50 (Marshall, 2025)

RedFlag

Problem Characteristics (THE GAP)

Convenience

Fact-checking often requires manual searching outside the platform.

Awareness

Users often receive no real-time credibility signals while browsing.

Motivation

Platforms and algorithms encourage instant sharing without friction.

Fragmentation

Many existing verification tools are platform-specific and not unified.

The Solution

RedFlag is a cross-platform browser extension that automatically detects and flags potentially misleading content in real time, providing credibility indicators and source links directly within the user's browsing experience.

RedFlag

Closing THE GAP

Convenience	Awareness	Motivation	Fragmentation
Real Time Integrated Detection	Real-Time detection	Frictionless Detection System	Multi-Platform capabilities

What it Will Do

How will RedFlag work?

Integrated Detection

- Integrated by a chrome extension to scan content automatically

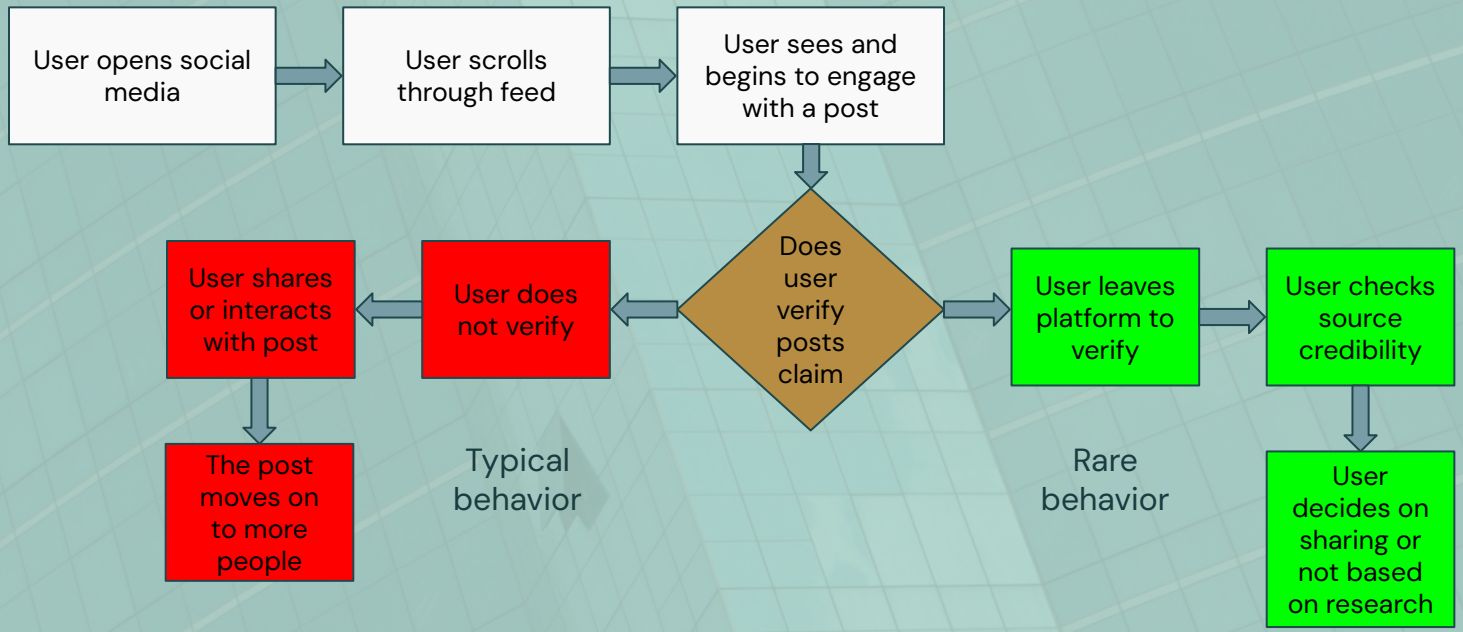
Real-Time Detection

- Highlights questionable information immediately

Frictionless but Complete

- Highlights require no user input
- Can deliver detailed overview on request

Solution Process Flow



COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Competitors

	Google Fact Check Explorer	News Guard	Community Notes	AI
FEATURES	• Search for stories by keyword, person, or image that have been debunked • Fact check other stories yourself	• Rates trustworthiness of a news source on a scale from 1-100 • Team of journalists fact checking	• Allows users to add contextual explanations or fact checks to posts • Other contributors rate notes for helpfulness, only helpful notes are shown	• Ask AI the veracity of a claim/source (e.g. @Grok is this true?) • AI uses its dataset to respond
STRENGTHS	• Quickly able to search for rumors or claims being made online • Aggregate source of online disinformation	• Real human input on trustworthiness • Partnered with organizations for better fact checking	• Posts remain visible with extra context added • Uses a diverse group of users to reduce bias	• Ease of use- users already familiar with service, easily available, immediate response • Low manpower required
WEAKNESSES	• Allows biased sources to fact check other sources • Does not provide input on every claim made online • No verified source of claims	• Possible bias due to human fact checkers •	• Slow response time makes notes appear long after a misleading post has spread • Organized groups can attempt to manipulate note ratings	• Frequently incorrect • Confidently wrong, fooling users • Dataset is fallible

Glossary

- Friction - something that causes an application to not be seamless while working.

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Development Tools

Major Functional Components

Major Functional Components Diagram

Risks

Appendix

Real World Product vs Prototype Table

Elevator Pitch

RedFlag is a browser extension designed to reduce the spread of online misinformation. It runs in the background while users browse social media and news sites and automatically highlights potentially false or misleading content directly on the screen. Instead of relying on users to fact-check information themselves, RedFlag brings awareness to misinformation at the moment it's encountered. With one click, users can view a short explanation and links to credible sources, helping them make informed decisions before believing or sharing content.